bring essential humanitarian aid to the enclave. Does it mean the end of the war? It looks that way, although in the long run Hamas may try again.

Tomorrow there will be a cabinet session about a partial allocation of the budget for 2023. Netanyahu and Smotrich want to keep intact the “coalition moneys” that were decided upon before the war, with billions for Orthodox education and the settlements, while Benny Gantz wants the whole budget to be devoted to war-related expenditures and help for the communities that had to be evacuated. In a letter to Netanyahu, Gantz made clear that if his demand was rejected, his party would have to consider its next steps.

Some 100,000 people marched in London against antisemitism. It was high time.

Monday, November 27

Eleven more Israeli hostages should be liberated today, but again there seem to be some difficulties. The Egyptians are optimistic, the Israelis less so. It seems, however, after hours of uncertainty, that the hostages will be released as initially foreseen. Six citizens of Thailand will also be released. There are negotiations for a prolongation of the ceasefire. Yet the mutual hatred between both sides is such that a resumption of hostilities is only a matter of time. Where is the kind of leader that Yitzhak Rabin was? What we have now is a self-centered trickster.

According to American and Qatari sources, after today’s exchange, the ceasefire will be prolonged by two days, which means the release of twenty more hostages. Today’s exchange almost didn’t take place, as Israel refused to accept the initial Hamas proposal that included nine children and two older women but not the children’s mothers. Finally an agreement was reached, thanks to President Biden’s energetic intervention: the two elderly women were replaced by two of the children’s mothers.